

rather take his family to a Dodgers' game than to a church service. His idea of a good time is a Manhattan on the rocks, a slow barbecue, and an evening of bridge with friends. Mac calls most of the people on his block friends as well as neighbors. But he seems to enjoy anyone's company, as long as they know how to laugh.

One day Mac asked if I'd ride with him to UCLA Medical Center to visit his sick wife. During the one-hour ride he told me his wife could be dying of "Lou Gehrig's disease." He paused for about twenty minutes, then said something I had never heard before:

"She's lived every day of her life exactly the way she wanted to. If we learn tomorrow she's only got a year or two left, we won't change a thing. We've always lived as if each day were our last. Life's too short to live any other way."

Six years after that ride to UCLA I heard something similar at Stanford Business School. At Stanford we called it "living in the here and now." Living each day as if it were our *only* day allows us to let go of past prejudices and to free ourselves from doubts about the future.

Living in the here and now can be compared to how a composer writes a score. First, a composer gets an idea for a melody. Past successes and failures come into play only insofar as they resolve into the creative birth of melody *today*. Once the composer sets the melody, he chooses a form—prelude, etude, etc. The form represents a guide, an outline for the future, and frees the composer to concentrate on writing measures. He works on the technical: sound, harmony, and texture. Sometimes he surprises himself and decides to start over with a new form, based on a new way he hears his melody. The whole of the piece comes into being only when the final form (future) and melody (present) fuse into a score.

Like the composer, we must live life's melody *today*. But every once in a while we need to get out of our here-and-now focus to examine the "form." We need to look down the